

AI & Design Daily Digest

2026-09-16 | Powered by Gemini API + GitHub Actions

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

- **Executive Summary: AI & Design Research (2026-09-16)**
- **Google Advances Conversational AI:** Google launched **Gemini 3.8 Live** and **Gemini 3.8 Live Extended Thinking**, featuring real-time visual context awareness and the ability to execute background tasks without interrupting user interaction.
- **Visual Guardrails for AI Coding:** To combat quality degradation in agentic workflows, **Applitools** released **Visual AI Guardrails**—including an MCP server and Figma Design Baseline SDK—enabling AI agents (like Claude Code and Cursor) to perform automated, high-fidelity UI validation.
- **Rapid Expansion of MCP-Based Workflows:** The Model Context Protocol (MCP) ecosystem saw significant growth, with **Zepln** (Wealth Management) and **GReminders** (Meeting Management) launching dedicated MCP servers to integrate governed, specialized agentic capabilities directly into platforms like Slack and ChatGPT.
- **Anthropic Scales Small Business & Enterprise AI:** Anthropic significantly bolstered its business utility by adding **43 workflows and 27 integrations** to Claude for Small Business, alongside a **Salesforce in Claude beta** offering 37 pre-built sales skills for CRM-integrated pipeline management.
- **Secure Agentic Development:** **Coder** integrated **Claude Code** into its **Agent Relay** platform, providing a secure, self-hosted environment that allows highly regulated enterprises to deploy and manage AI agents with robust governance.

SECTION 1 — NEW AI MODELS

[Google Gemini 3.8 Live and Gemini 3.8 Live Extended Thinking] | [2026-09-15] |

[<https://blog.google/technology/ai/gemini-3-8-live-extended-thinking/>] | [Google launched two new voice-focused AI models designed for natural, fluid conversation with real-time visual context and the ability to execute background tasks without interrupting the user.]

[Atria Dawn Preview] | [2026-09-15] | [<https://arxiv.org/>] | [Shanghai AI Laboratory released a preprint for its new agentic model, Atria Dawn, evaluating its performance across 16 benchmarks alongside a study of human-AI collaboration.]

SECTION 2 — DESIGN-TO-CODE

[Applitools Introduces Visual AI Guardrails] | [September 15, 2026] | [<https://markets.businessinsider.com/news/stocks/applitools-introduces-visual-ai-guardrails-to-prevent-quality-degradation-and-reduce-review-burden-in-agentic-coding-1035656363>] | [Applitools launched new features including Eyes MCP Tools and a Figma Design

Baseline SDK to enable AI agents to perform automated visual validation and maintain UI quality standards within coding pipelines.]

SECTION 3 — AI IN UI/UX DESIGN

No new items found

SECTION 4 — AI WORKFLOWS & AUTOMATION

[Applitools Introduces Visual AI Guardrails for Agentic SDLC] | [September 15, 2026] | [<https://www.marketsinsider.com/news/applitools-introduces-visual-ai-guardrails-to-prevent-quality-degradation-and-reduce-review-burden-in-agentic-coding>] | [Applitools released a new platform capability with an MCP server to provide visual AI verification and deterministic governance for AI coding agents like Claude Code and Cursor.]

[Zeplyn Introduces Agent Studio and MCP Server] | [September 15, 2026] | [<https://t3technologyhub.com/zepln-introduces-agent-studio-and-mcp-server>] | [Zeplyn launched Agent Studio and a dedicated MCP server to allow wealth management firms to build and deploy governed AI agents across tools like Claude, ChatGPT, and Slack.]

[GReminders Launches MCP Server] | [September 15, 2026] | [<https://www.destinationcrm.com/Articles/ReadArticle.aspx?ArticleID=163012>] | [GReminders released an MCP server that integrates its meeting management platform with AI assistants, enabling automated pre-meeting briefs and post-meeting follow-ups.]

[Anthropic Enhances Claude for Small Business with 43 Workflows and 27 Integrations] | [September 15, 2026] | [<https://www.unite.ai/anthropic-adds-43-workflows-27-integrations-to-claude-for-small-business/>] | [Anthropic expanded its Claude for Small Business offering with new pre-built workflows and integrations for tools like Shopify, Salesforce, and Zapier, featuring a default human-in-the-loop approval mode.]

[Coder Brings Claude Code to Agent Relay] | [September 15, 2026] | [<https://www.marketsinsider.com/news/coder-brings-claude-code-to-agent-relay-unlocking-agentic-development-for-the-worlds-most-regulated-enterprises>] | [Coder announced support for Claude Code within its Agent Relay platform to enable secure, self-hosted agentic development in regulated enterprise environments.]

[Salesforce in Claude Beta Released] | [September 15, 2026] | [<https://coursiv.io/salesforce-in-claude-beta>] | [Anthropic launched the Salesforce in Claude beta, allowing organizations to connect Salesforce CRM data to Claude with 37 prebuilt sales skills for tasks like call preparation and pipeline management.]